Aurora Galactica: 10-Day V1 Execution Plan

A practical plan to ship `v1`, reduce launch risk, and land the highest-value architectural seams without stopping for a full platform refactor before release.

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Purpose

This plan is designed to do four things at once:

1. finish the current `v1` launch push
2. reduce launch risk materially
3. strengthen the regression and release pipeline
4. add enough architectural seams that the codebase remains evolvable after launch

> **Key decision:** the next 10 days should target *launch + thin-seam refactor*, not a full generalized arcade platform.

Success Definition

- Aurora Galactica is ready to launch as `v1`, or is one very small final decision away from promotion.
- The launch blocker list is short, stable, and justified.
- The beta-review cluster is largely closed or downgraded to low-risk polish.
- Stage 2 and Stage 4 fairness have better tuning and stronger evidence than today.
- Release-readiness materials are complete: security review, code docs, consistent public docs, and a short players guide.
- The runtime has thin architectural seams: `gameDef`, data-driven tuning, optional-system boundaries, and stable telemetry vocabulary.

Scope

In Scope

- Launch blockers and beta-review closure
- Stage 2 and Stage 4 fairness tuning
- Security review and release-readiness pass
- Players guide and documentation refresh
- Production vs non-production data-path separation
- Thin-seam refactor work that helps Aurora immediately

Out of Scope

- Full arcade-platform extraction
- Implementing Galaxian as a second game
- Generalized multi-game runtime/menu
- Large speculative framework work
- Theme/template expansion unrelated to launch

Operating Model

Track	Owners	Focus	Output
Gameplay Strike Team	2 agents	`#18`, `#32`, `#38`, `#74/#47`, manual-beta feedback	Tuned gameplay changes and beta-ready builds
Rules / Capture / Challenge Team	1 agent	`#40`, `#73`, `#77`, `#78`, `#80`, `#88`	Closed or downgraded correctness risks
Architecture / Thin-Seam Team	2 agents	`gameDef`, tuning tables, optional systems, decoupling	Cleaner runtime boundaries without behavior regressions
Harness / Regression Team	1-2 agents	Pressure guards, flaky scenarios, personas, acceptance suite	Trustworthy regression signal
Release / Docs / Product Team	1 agent	`#76`, `#85`, `#86`, players guide, security review	Launch-ready product surface and support materials

Recommended team size: 7 to 8 active agents plus one coordinating lead.

Core Principles

1. No broad refactor without a regression guard.
2. No speculative platform work that does not help Aurora today.
3. Every gameplay change needs a manual reason, a harness bar, and a rollback path.
4. Refactor work must be seam-oriented, not aesthetic.
5. If the plan slips, cut platform ambition before cutting launch integrity.

10-Day Timeline

Day	Theme	Primary Work	Exit Criteria
1	Stabilize review cluster	Close or sharply re-scope beta-review items; capture/challenge/squadron presentation cleanup	Cluster smaller and more explicit
2	Finish mechanic guards	Extend critical automation and reduce flaky harness ambiguity	Mechanic-level confidence is higher and cleaner
3	Stage 2 fairness	Tune dive geometry and lane convergence using pressure metrics	`#32` improved or narrowed with evidence
4	Stage 4 fairness	Tune escort/convergence pressure using the pressure guard	`#18` improved or narrowed with evidence
5	Thin seams part 1	Introduce `gameDef`; move obvious rules/tuning into data	Runtime is cleaner and still stable
6	Thin seams part 2	Optional-system boundaries, telemetry stability, more data-driven tuning	Seams are real, not aspirational
7	Release integrity	`#76`, security review, release-surface sanity pass	Environment strategy is implemented or locked
8	Docs and product surface	Code docs, materials refresh, players guide, UI polish from `#86`	Launch materials are coherent and user-ready
9	Final beta sweep	Acceptance suite, manual beta pass, public surface verification	Blocker list is short and decision-ready
10	Launch decision	Final blocker review, release notes, production promotion if ready	Launch or explicit small final punch list

Deliverables

Gameplay

- Stage 2 fairness pass
- Stage 4 fairness pass
- Final squadron readability decision
- Ship-loss feel decision

Architecture

- `gameDef` seam
- Stage-tuning data tables
- Optional-system boundaries
- Stable telemetry vocabulary

Harness

- Reliable mechanic guards
- Stable pressure check
- Less flaky scenario behavior
- Persona recalibration after difficulty changes

Release

- Environment split decision and implementation
- Security review
- Code documentation pass

- Players guide and public materials refresh

Risks And Mitigations

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Stage 2 / Stage 4 tuning takes longer than expected	These remain the most meaningful gameplay blockers.	Dedicated owners, persona/pressure metrics, and quick reverts when a pass clearly regresses.
Thin-seam refactor creates late regressions	Structural churn can silently change gameplay.	Only land seam-oriented work behind harness guards and preserve rollback paths.
Harness flakiness corrupts decision-making	Good changes get blocked by noisy tests.	Dedicated harness ownership, cleaner timeouts, quarantine known-flaky paths.
Documentation and release work gets squeezed	That creates sloppy launches even if gameplay is good.	Separate release/docs track with work starting before Day 10.
Scope creep toward full platformization	That risks missing both launch and architecture goals.	Hold the line on thin seams only; defer full engine extraction and second-game work.

Decision Rules If We Slip

Cut First

1. Broad architectural ambition
2. Non-essential UI polish
3. Lower-priority post-`v1` documentation polish

Do Not Cut

1. Launch integrity

2. Stage 2 and Stage 4 fairness work
3. Critical mechanic regression coverage
4. Security and release-readiness review

Thin-Seam Investments To Keep

- `gameDef`
- Stage-tuning data tables
- Explicit optional systems
- Mechanic-level harness abstractions
- Stable telemetry vocabulary

These are the highest-value incremental investments because they improve Aurora today and directly reduce the cost of post-`v1` platformization.

Final Recommendation

The best achievable 10-day plan is:

1. launch Aurora Galactica `v1`
2. strengthen the harness and release workflow
3. land thin seams that keep the project evolvable
4. defer full platform extraction until immediately after release

That gets the product out the door without trapping the codebase in a non-evolvable state.